

An Inquisitive Queue AI Series

Intentional Questions

Harnessing AI to ask better, live
better and do better



Harshil Shah

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Prologue

The cartograph of Curiosity

The map presented above is not merely a visual guide. It's a symbolic journey inviting you to explore the realms of this breakthrough technology called AI by mindfulness and intention. Like all great adventures, it begins not with answers, but with better questions.

Each Realm in this map represents a chapter, offering its own terrain and topic. You can click on any realm from the map to move to that page directly:

- Realm 0: The Threshold Point

Your first step, where doubt meets wonder. You find that you don't need to be an expert to explore AI meaningfully.

- Realm 1: The Forest of Clarity

A misty forest where confusion clears. Learn what AI truly is, without jargon or fear.

- Realm 2: The Cavern of Prompts

Echoes of wisdom bounce off its walls. Master the art of asking better questions—your most powerful key to unlocking AI's magic.

- Realm 3: The Mountain of Applications

A rugged climb, rich with practicality. Discover how AI can serve your everyday life, from meals to minimalism.

- Realm 4: The Waterfall of Tools

A flow of useful platforms. Find friendly, approachable AI services to amplify your creativity and make routine efficient.

- Realm 5: The Typhoon of Blunders

Where storms test your footing. Understand the risks of AI overuse, misinformation, and privacy.

- Realm 6: The Lake of Awareness

Still waters run deep. Reflect, realign, and integrate ancient wisdom to balance AI tech with mindfulness.

- Realm 7: The Bridge of Future

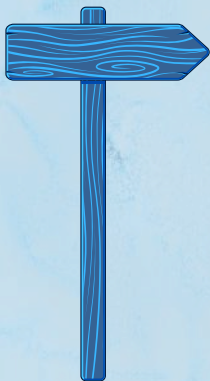
Gaze toward tomorrow. Step lightly into sharing the intentional AI knowledge with others as part of a conscious world.

- Realm ∞: The Questioning Continues

A glimmer in the distance. Your journey with questions never ends—it evolves. Here begins your own mapmaking.

This book isn't just read—it's played, explored, and lived. This way, we are able to make learning interesting. Each realm (chapter) comes with checkpoints to reflect and tokens to collect, helping you unlock insights and level up your understanding. I hope you have fun reading and exploring this book as much as I had by creating it!

Realm 0 **The Threshold Point**



The threshold point

You have a map in your hands. You are in the woods, feeling lost. A quiet hush surrounds you as you step toward the edge of something unknown. The ground beneath is familiar, but the horizon ahead shimmers with potential. A soft breeze carries a scent of ink, paper, and possibility. There it stands—the Threshold Point as seen on the map. You don't know what awaits, but you choose to start the journey. And that, dear reader, is everything.

You reach near the point, and find out a scroll lying in the corner. You lift it and read...

As you roll the letter, you feel a shift. It is time you tune in. You take your first step towards the forest of clarity. The path winds gently. Ahead, seven realms await—each with a new terrain and tokens. But for now, you're exactly where you need to be.

Dear Explorer,

Welcome to the journey of Intentional Questions. This journey does not require a passport of code, credentials, or cutting-edge knowledge.

Here, we trade confusion for clarity, fear for curiosity, and overload for intention.

You may have heard whispers of AI—some promising wonders, others warning catastrophe. But between those extremes lies a quieter path. This book is your guide to that middle way: where asking better questions leads to better productivity.

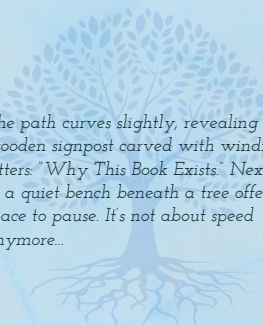
Let your curiosity be your compass & your questions be your torch. This world isn't only reserved for experts, but also made richer by explorers like you.

Walk forward. Ask well

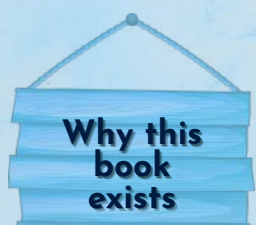
- AIQ.

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What drew you to this book?
- What do you hope to explore & understand after reading?



The path curves slightly, revealing a wooden signpost carved with winding letters: "Why This Book Exists." Next to it, a quiet bench beneath a tree offers space to pause. It's not about speed anymore...



Why this book exists

In a world of infinite noise, where AI trends sprint ahead of your attention, *Intentional Questions* offers a much-needed pause.

I believe the future of AI isn't only in labs—it's in kitchens, living rooms, classrooms, cafés. It belongs in the hands of everyday people asking questions not just to machines—but to life and to themselves.

This is not about keeping up to what's new. It's about reclaiming control in a tech-driven world. I think it can happen by knowing the tech itself clearly. Here, that technology is AI.

You won't find jargon here. Instead, you'll find ideas you can feel, reflections you can use, and tools that support the way you think, create, and be productive personally and professionally.

This book exists because the best questions don't need to be complex. They just need curious person like you who intends to learn and grow.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What role does tech, in general, play in your life today?
- Do you feel in control of your digital tools—or the other way around?

*Past the bench, a winding stream
glistens in the sun. As you kneel near
the water, images ripple across the
surface—your music app
recommending a playlist, a calendar
adjusting itself, or a recipe popping up
just when you were thinking of lunch.*

**You're
already
using AI**

AI isn't waiting to be discovered in the world we live in. It's already with you—silently & invisibly integrated into your daily life.

When your phone keyboard autocorrects a word, that's AI, to put it simply. When your favourite video streaming app offers a show you love or cues up a perfect next film for you to watch, that's AI, too.

When your smart speaker plays your evening playlist before you even ask for it—that's right—it's AI. There are so many places where AI is being used without us knowing about it.

In conclusion, it is already part of your everyday life. This book simply reveals the intention behind how you can use it more mindfully and efficiently.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Can you list 3 ways AI quietly helps you each week?
- Which of those feels helpful? Which might feel intrusive?

A bridge appears next—worn but sturdy. Carved into its stone are names: *The Curious. The Learners. The Dreamers. The Doers.* You cross it, and feel yourself belong.

Who this book is for

This book is for:

- The Curious - People who sense there's more to this AI buzz and want to understand it without feeling overwhelmed.
- The Learners - Those who love to explore new ideas of AI and share them with others.
- The Creators - Artists, writers & thinkers who want to use AI to amplify-not replace-their voice.
- The Conscious Navigators - Those mindful of their digital lives and seeking alignment between their tools and values without giving up either.
- The Beginners - Anyone starting from zero. Because there is no "late" when it comes to learning anything. There is only "now".

If you are open, curious, and willing to explore, then this book is for you.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which one of the reader types feels like you? What strengths do you bring into this journey?
- What excites you most about learning something new?

*Just before the trail ends, a trail of glitter
shines above you. It slowly etches words into
the sky like light through ink: "You're not late.
You're right on time."*



I questioned myself when I was overwhelmed upon seeing the rapid revolution AI brought (and still brings) everywhere. This served as my motivation and inspired me to just continue:

You are not behind.

You are not unqualified.

You are neither too old nor too young.

You are at the threshold—a beautiful beginning—to learning a breakthrough technology called AI.

You have questions. You are eager to learn. That's all you need. AI isn't here to replace you. It's here to reflect you. And it becomes more meaningful when guided by your unique intentions.

Let go of hesitation. Continue on the path you have taken.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What does "you are not late" mean to you in your life right now?
- What's something you've put off learning that now feels possible?

Quest 0

The Curious Beginner

As you take a final step to the Forest of Clarity, a mystic door appears locked, marked with your zeroth quest. Accept it, complete it and the key to unlock the door - Compass of Confidence - will be yours.

Choose any one AI tool you know you already use (like YouTube, Spotify, MidJourney, ChatGPT, etc.). Spend one day mindfully noticing how it makes decisions for you.

Ask yourself these:

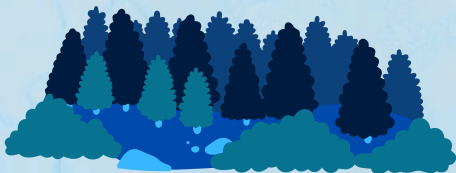
- What did it suggest/recommend?
- How accurate or helpful was it?
- How would I use this differently if I were more intentional?

Record your observations in the space provided or in a notebook. That's it.

Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Compass of Confidence



Realm 1 The Forest of Clarity



Through the mist

You finally step into the forest after unlocking the door with token's help. The air is thick with fog, the path uncertain. All around you, trees whisper words like "machine learning" & "algorithms".

It's easy to feel lost here. But look again—this forest isn't here to confuse you.

It's here to teach you to see.

You pick up a lantern. The lantern of inquisitiveness. With each step, the fog begins to lift. Shadows become shapes. Buzzwords turn into metaphors. And the deeper you go, the clearer it gets. You begin to realize—you don't need to be an expert to understand and utilize AI.

You just need to be present, aware, and open.

This is the Forest of Clarity. Breathe in. Let's begin.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What do you already know about AI?
- Why do you want to learn about AI?

The air clears. The winds blows gently. The sun, which was hidden, shines again.



What is AI?

Artificial Intelligence (AI) isn't magic. And it's not out of reach either. At its core, AI is a system trained to recognize patterns (from questions asked by users) and generate responses. That's it. It "learns" by processing lots of data and finding the most likely answer to a question or task given. Machine Learning (ML) is a branch of AI where models learn from the data to predict and suggest the likely outcomes.

In plain language, think of AI systems as really smart assistants who have read billions of books and remember all of them—but only tell you what it thinks you want to hear.

If it still sounds complex, then try this:

- AI is like a recipe book that learns what you like to eat.
- ML is how the recipe book updates its suggestions based on your choices.

You don't need to know how the oven works to enjoy a good meal. Likewise, you don't need to know all the math behind AI/ML to use it wisely. We will mainly focus on using AI efficiently moving forward.

Prompt wave:

Note: These waves are for you to practise given prompts with any AI tool you find suitable. In case you want to learn about tools first, visit realm 4 by clicking the icon on the right and then come back here after finishing it.

Ask these questions to AI tool of your choice:

- Can you explain what AI is to a curious 8-year-old?
- Pretend I'm from the 1800s. What's AI?



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which analogy did you find the most helpful? Do you feel more comfortable with the term now?
- How would you describe AI to a friend?



Way to Realm 4
The waterfall of tools

In the dense part of the forest, myths grow like moss on the trees. It's time to gently brush them off.

What AI is not

AI is not conscious. It doesn't feel. At least, not right now. AI is not perfect. It makes mistakes—sometimes confidently. AI is not a threat by default. Like any technology, it depends on how it's used. These are some common misconceptions about AI that should be cleared:

- "AI will replace me at workplace."

No. AI assists, but humans still lead with empathy, ethics, and creativity. AI can help in writing a book. It can plan. It can write. But, it can not plan, write and execute the writing of book completely by itself without human intervention.

- "AI knows everything."

It has humongous knowledge base, yes, but it generates answers only based on the patterns and data fed into it. It predicts answers on the basis of the data quality and algorithms developed by humans.

- "I'm too old for this."

Wisdom and curiosity are ageless. AI just adds a new tool to your arsenal to grow further.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What beliefs did you hold about AI that feel different now?
- Has your view shifted?

Quest 1 The Fog Breaker

As the woods disappear gradually, a mystic wall appears in front of you, marked with your first quest. Accept it, complete it and the weapon to break the wall - Hammer of Wisdom - will be yours.

Explain what AI is to someone in your life using your own words. This could be a child, a parent, a friend, or even yourself in your journal. Use a metaphor, a story, or a conversation. Keep it simple & kind. Finally, to recap what you've learnt, try to answer the following:

- What is the difference between AI and ML?
- Is AI always able to give accurate information?
- Which was one fact or insight that resonated the most with you in this realm?

Check answers by asking the very same questions to AI chatbot of your choice. Score doesn't matter. What matters is reflection & clarity.

*Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Hammer of Wisdom*



Realm 2

The Cavern of Prompts



Echoes in the dark

The forest clears behind you after the wall is broken. A great stone cavern rises before you. Inside, it's dark, but not silent. You hear echoes-not of voices, but of questions.

Questions of all types bounce off the walls of cavern:

Curious ones.
Courageous ones.
Brilliant ones.
Foolish ones.

They raise the intensity with each repetition.

In the heart of this cave lies an ancient truth: *the question shapes the answer*. To wield AI well, you must master not knowledge, but inquiry.

Traverse through the Cavern of Prompts.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Why questioning matters according to you?
- How do you frame your question while asking to someone?

You travel through the cavern for what feels like eternity, and suddenly find the secrets etched on the sides, fire torches making them even brighter.

The ancient art of asking well

AI is like a genie-but it follows your words exactly. The spell lies not in the code (algorithm), but in your command (prompt). A prompt is anything you say or type to an AI system. It can be a question, a task, a command, or even a poem you begin for the AI to continue. Learning how to ask is key to mastering any AI tool.

Check this example prompt:

Bad prompt: "Help me with online marketing."

Better prompt: "Give me 3 creative social media post ideas for a sustainable clothing brand targeting Gen-Z and millennials."

The difference lies in clarity, detail & intention. Remember these golden rules of prompting:

- **Be Specific:** The more detail you provide, the better the AI can help.
- **Give Context:** Tell the AI who it should act like or who you're, what your goal is, and what tone you want.
- **Think Like a Director:** You're not just asking. You're guiding AI to refine if it doesn't provide intended response on the first try. Act as a friend while crafting prompts. If you avoid being vague and unclear, you will get great responses.

Prompt wave:

Try & observe these prompts designed for specific Real Roles:

- **Parent:** "Create a bedtime story for my 5-year-old about kindness, with animal characters."
- **Student:** "Summarize the gradient descent topic into 5 bullet points for a class presentation."
- **Freelancer:** "Draft a proposal email to a client for a logo redesign project."
- **Self-Care Seeker:** "Suggest 10 mindful activities I can do in 10 minutes during a busy day."

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What did you learn about how you ask questions?
- Which role-based prompt could help in your own life?

You hear echoes as you walk further, which grow louder step-after-step. The deeper truths are echoing rhythmically to reveal them to you.

Power of prompts

AI becomes as powerful as the questions you ask. It is an echo of your questions and the persona you show while asking. You can teach it your tone, share your priorities, and ask it to respond like a coach, partner, or advisor. Building on the previous tips, here are more ways of writing prompts wisely:

- *Begin with the end in mind:* What are you trying to do exactly by asking a question to an AI model?
- *Add your tone:* Like professional, casual, poetic, playful, sarcastic, etc. depending upon the situation to refine the vibe.
- *Formatting:* You can also add the format of the answer you are expecting (such as lists, tables, emojis, etc.).
- *Test variations:* Try the same prompt three different ways like so:
"Write an article on mindfulness in 300 words in a formal manner." OR
"How is mindfulness relevant in current era? Write an essay in 300 words and reason it." OR
"You are a meditation expert. Write a detailed article to submit at a renowned publication explaining mindfulness & its significance." This way, it will act like a specific personality, thereby giving specific responses only related to your needs.

Prompt wave:

Use this template and create your own prompts for a specific use-case of your choice:

- "Act as a [role] and help me with [task]."
- "List pros and cons of [topic] in [number] words."
- "Brainstorm ideas for [domain/goal] with a [tone]."
- "Help me explain [concept] to [type of person]."

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What kind of "prompt personality" do you naturally have-broad or precise?
- How do you feel about your ability to guide AI now?

The echoes slow down and a wise old voice speaks: "Follow these advices of my disciples, and you will master the magic of prompts. Since you have listened patiently, you get this potion to further make prompts more powerful". A potion appears...



The prompts do not need to be lengthy. However, the more information given depending on the task, the better it becomes for AI to generate its response, especially in the beginning of a conversation. These are the methods to be a master at prompting:

- **Give examples or style:** Examples act like templates for the AI to follow. Example: "Write 5 affirmations in a calming tone, like this: 'I trust my journey.'" OR Create social post captions with emojis like this one: 'Fuel your mind & body daily.'
- **Use prompt stacking:** Break any long prompt into smaller steps. You'll get better answer in stages. Example: First prompt: "Give me a list of finance topics for a blog." Follow-up prompt: "Now write an outline for the first topic." 3. Follow-up prompt: "Turn the outline into a short article with a friendly, yet insightful tone."
- **Add constraints or rules:** Along with length limits, tell AI what not to do. Example: "Give me 5 habits to start meditation, each under 20 words." OR "Avoid technical terms. Make it feel light and motivational."
- **Ask for revisions/enhancements:** If response is not upto the mark, add even finer details to revise. Example: "Make this simpler." OR "Revise your last response with a more inspirational tone."

Prompt wave:

Use these examples and refine them to enhance your everyday life & routine:

- "Make a grocery list for 3 meals per day with only 5 ingredients."
- "Turn this note into a professional email."
- "Summarize this article in one sentence."
- "Give me a 10-min morning routine to boost focus. Keep the tone energetic."
- "Help me prepare questions for a job interview."

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which method is the best one as per you?
- Which templates resonate with you or your needs?

Quest 2 The Echo Shaper

As the darkness begins to reduce, you breathe a sigh of relief. Suddenly, a mystic net appears in front of cavern's end, marked with your second quest. Accept it, complete it and the tool to shape the net - Scissor of Knowledge - will be yours.

- Create 5 personalized prompts to help you in daily life. One for work/study, one for personal life, one for learning AI, one for upgrading your life, and one just for fun. Then, ask your favourite AI-Image generation tool to make 5 cards-each with a prompt you created with rich visuals using prompt techniques you learnt. Did you like them on the first time?

- Try each prompt you generated just now with an AI tool of your choice. Is it providing responses as expected? Note how it responds and tweak your prompt to improve the answer.

- Share your best prompt with someone and explain why it works.

*Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Scissor of Knowledge*



Realm 3

The Mountain of Applications





The cavern fades behind you after you cut the net. As you step into the light, the terrain shifts beneath your feet. You find yourself at the base of a vast & rugged mountain.

The wind whispers challenges. The path is steep but carved with footsteps—proof that others have climbed before you.

This is The Mountain of Applications—where theory meets practice, and curiosity becomes capability.

As you ascend, you'll learn how to use AI not as a mystery, but as a companion in your daily life.

Your gear? Your curiosity. Your intent. And now, a new tool: your prompts.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which are your most important aspects of your life where you think AI can make significant improvements?
- Did you already try applying prompt methods in those aspects?

The climb is easier at the beginning with lesser curves and smooth rocks. Or is it?

Questions that move mountains

The right question doesn't just get you an answer—it gets you movement.

Now that you understand how to prompt, let's look at how to apply prompts for daily clarity and ease.

Prompt Wave:

Given are different scenarios for using AI in daily life and prompt examples for you to experiment, some of which are repeated from previous examples for more understanding. Try combining more than one from these and observe the answers generated:

- Vacation Planning: "Create a 4-day travel itinerary in Rishikesh with meditation and quality yoga retreats, staying under 10K."
- Budgeting: "Break down my monthly income of 90K into savings, rent, food, and fun with percentages and targets."
- Time Management: "Help me block my week with work, self-care, and rest using a time-blocking approach."
- Gift Brainstorming: "Suggest 5 thoughtful gift ideas for my dad who loves gardening."
- Meal Planning: "Plan a vegetarian meal prep menu for 3 days for 2 people that's high-protein and uses minimal ingredients."
- Fitness: "Design a 3-day home cardio & hypertrophy workout routine for someone with no equipment and 45 minutes a day."
- Learning: "Create a 7-day crash course on basic video editing using free tools."

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which of these examples felt immediately useful to your life?
- What task have you been putting off that AI could help simplify?

As you move upwards to the peak, you see a set of plants glowing and exuding enormous amount of energy towards you. The energy is helping you climb faster than before.

**Your
superpowered
assistant**

You don't need to be tech-savvy to let AI work for you. All you need is a goal, and the courage to ask for help. Productivity increases multi-fold when AI is used the right way. Tasks can be done efficiently and swiftly.

Prompt Wave:

Here's how AI becomes your practical partner in other two significant areas of your life- work and self-care:

- Email Drafting: "Write a polite email asking a client for a deadline extension of project due to unavoidable circumstances."
- Job Search: "Make a compelling one-paragraph bio for a resume in marketing with 5 years of experience."
- Hiring: "Make a comprehensive job description for a role of Java Software Developer with 2 years of minimum experience for a Logistics company."
- Burnout Support: "Suggest 3 simple ways to reduce workplace stress during a busy week."
- Report: "Rewrite this report in a professional tone with bullet points and headers while highlighting the significance of proper asset allocation."
- Creative Writing: "Write a short poem about rediscovering joy, in a hopeful tone."
- Journaling for Clarity: "Ask me 5 reflection questions about my week."
- Spiritual Exploration: "Give me a calming mantra and explain its meaning."

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What kind of support do you still expect from AI after learning what it can do already?
- Where is AI still rarely used and should be used more, according to you?

Quest 3 **The Peak Conqueror**

As the clouds appear over your head and you reach the peak, a mystic wormhole appears in front of you, marked with your third quest. Accept it, complete it and the vehicle to travel the wormhole - Spaceship of Productivity - will be yours.

Where do you feel the most disorganized or overwhelmed in your life right now? Apply AI to three such areas of your life.

Examples:

- Meal or grocery planning
- Scheduling your week
- Drafting a difficult message or email
- Brainstorming for your startup
- Budgeting your next month
- Planning a creative project
- Managing a learning goal

Use AI to help with each task and reflect on the results.

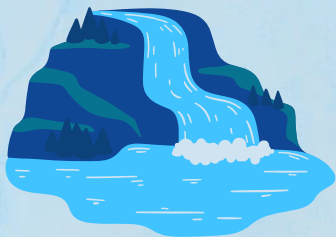
What worked for you? What did you try asking AI that actually surprised you with how helpful it was?

*Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Spaceship of Productivity*



Realm 4

The Waterfall of Tools



When the flow finds you

The climb empowered you, and you crossed the wormhole with spaceship's help, now entering in a new world. The mountain looks familiar to the last one, but there is a voice not present before...

The voice is a deep, resonant rush. The sound of momentum.

The Waterfall of Tools emerges like liquid lightning—an endless cascade of possibilities, each stream carrying practical magic to make your life lighter, more beautiful, and deeply intentional.

Here, the tools are not intimidating. They are like rafts floating gently toward you, waiting for your signal to be utilized.

This realm isn't about knowing all the answers. It is about discovering the right companions for the right task.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which AI tools are you already using regularly?
- Why are there different tools for different tasks?

Each tool here is a raft you can climb into. They're designed to carry and support you gently, not pull you under.

Rafts of support

By now, you've shaped questions via prompts, summoned answers, and applied AI in your life. Now it's time to unlock another layer—tools that bring those prompts to life through text, visuals, audio, scheduling, planning, self-care and more. We will discuss only the most useful tools that can get work done without complex jargons.

- *What it's for:* It has become ubiquitous tool for quite some time now, and is mainly helpful with writing, coding, learning, brainstorming and editing.
- *Why you'd use it:* It thinks with you. Whether it's journaling or job applications, it is your co-writer and helps plan and organize your ideas. With addition of image generation in the latest models, you can even visualize your words and then use it to expand your creativity further. Access ChatGPT [here](#).



Prompt Wave:

Note: If you have come here directly from realm 1, you can click on the icon below on any of the following pages to go back.

- "Read this long article and create an image containing its gist [Share article]"
- "Help me brainstorm Instagram captions for a travel blog for this image [Upload image along with this prompt]"
- "Write a code in python for finding total number of words in this book."

Parallel Ripples:

Note: These are equally great and useful tools with very similar use-cases like the one mentioned above. They are mentioned here for you to explore further.

- [Gemini](#), [Claude](#), [Grok](#), [Llama](#), [Mistral](#).

Back to Realm 1
The forest of clarity

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What kind of writing or thinking tasks often drain your energy?
- Have you tried using AI to start something you've been putting off?

An illustration of a blue oval shape containing several small white rafts with blue oars, floating on a light blue background.

Rafts of support

- **What it's for:** Making beautiful visuals just with the help of words. It can now design interactive elements, make spreadsheets and even add AI voiceovers.
- **Why you'd use it:** No design experience needed. Create social media posts, posters, vision boards, resumes, videos and more. Many of the elements are versatile to be used in creation of websites, images and videos, which can make it seamlessly easy to use for an intricate multimedia project. Access Canva AI [here](#).

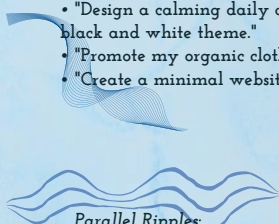
An illustration of a blue playground slide with a blue ladder and a blue platform at the top. The text 'Tool 2: Canva AI' is written in blue on the slide.

Tool 2: Canva AI

Your inner designer's playground

Prompt Wave:

- "Design a calming daily affirmation poster with abstract background in black and white theme."
- "Promote my organic clothing brand with rich visuals and engaging content"
- "Create a minimal website layout for a book shop (with code)."

An illustration of a blue wavy line, resembling a ripple in water, on a light blue background.

Parallel Ripples:

Note: These are equally great and useful tools with very similar use-cases like the one mentioned above. They are mentioned here for you to explore further.

- [MidJourney](#), [Microsoft Designer](#), [Stable Diffusion](#).

An illustration of a blue road with a white dashed line, curving upwards. A blue signpost with a white arrow points to the left, with the text 'Back to Realm 1 The forest of clarity' written on it.

Back to Realm 1
The forest of clarity

An illustration of a blue flag on a black pole, with a blue square next to it.

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What kind of designing or sketching tasks often drain your energy?
- Which visuals you created enrich your online/offline space, mood, or life?

- *What it's for:* Smart scheduling and time-blocking.
- *Why you'd use it:* It organizes your day, handles meetings, and gives space for rest, thereby creating work-life balance. It also helps in sharing meeting links quickly when time is of essence.

Example:

- "Add deep work sessions every morning, exercise thrice a week, and break reminders every 90 minutes."

Access Reclaim AI [here](#).

Parallel Ripples:

Note: These are equally great and useful tools albeit with different use-cases from the one mentioned above and below. They are mentioned here for you to explore further.

- [Notion AI](#) [Perplexity](#).

- *What it's for:* Smart note-taking and summarization of links, videos & docs.
- *Why you'd use it:* It summarizes almost any form of media, including videos and long documents and even creates podcast-like audio summaries of the created 'notebooks'. It also helps in creating quizzes and questions out of content shared in order to test, if required.

Example:

- "[Add links of lecture videos to a notebook session] Summarize these Calculus video lectures within 100 words with important formulae to remember. "

Access NotebookLM [here](#).

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What parts of your day feel chaotic or reactive after using AI?
- Are you searching aimlessly on these tools, or asking purposefully?

Rafts of support

Tool 3: Reclaim AI

Your calendar's smart brain

Back to Realm 1
The forest of clarity

Tool 4: NotebookLM

Your omnipresent note assistant

Quest 4 The Master Paddler

As the flow silences with time, you learn to ride the different rafts. Suddenly, a mystic vortex appears in front of you, marked with your fourth quest. Accept it, complete it and the way to survive the vortex - Lifeguard of Transformation - will be yours.

Choose any one of the tools mentioned above (you can even choose from "parallel ripples" section). Use it for real tasks.

Suggestions:

- Use ChatGPT to draft something you've been avoiding all along.
- Create a vision board or poster in Canva for your inspiration.
- Block time on Reclaim for your most important focus task.
- Ask NotebookLM to summarize 10 playlists on the toughest topic you know.

Once you complete the task, reflect:

- What did you create or solve with the tool?
- Did the experience feel empowering, frustrating, or freeing?
- Would you try to teach this to someone else?

Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Lifeguard of Transformation



Realm 5

The Typhoon of Blunders



When the winds rise

You survive the vortex, and move towards the ground. A small hut is seen. Suddenly, the ground rumbles. Winds howl in circles above. The water is crushing harder from the falls. You swim at the edge of a raging typhoon—not of rain or thunder, but of choices.

Here in this realm, you'll meet the shadows.
Not with fear, but with clarity.

The tools you've learnt to wield, the prompts
you've carefully crafted, and the AI
companions you now trust—they hold power.
And with power comes the need to pause,
question, and protect your own identity.

This is about fighting the odds and come out of
the typhoon with calmness.

If you've ever asked, "Am I using this too
much?"
Or worried, "Is my data safe?"
Or felt drained after spending hours online
interacting with these AI tools...

Then you are in the right place.
The real instrument you need now is Balance.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which are the biggest concerns of using AI according to you?
- What is mindfulness by your definition?

The calm in the middle of the typhoon is brief and small, but provides relief nonetheless. It shows you that there are tradeoffs for everything...

Eye of the storm - Pros

The advantages of AI must have been experienced by you until now, as we travelled across the realms. Some of which are presented here for the sake of completeness:

- AI saves a lot of time and energy, making us efficient in our mundane and repetitive tasks.
- AI supports brainstorming and learning, thereby providing us instant tutoring and guidance whenever necessary which is absolutely necessary if you are a philomath.
- AI boosts creativity and output at any workplace. It makes us think and ponder harder, and reflects more when used correctly.
- AI helps you simplify the complex by mentoring and being the wise. It is a coach, a master, an assistant and- at the same time- a friend when it comes to getting help.

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Are there any more advantages to using AI?
- Is AI present in every aspect of your life?

The shadows are visible, and that brief calm prompted you to see everything that is surrounding you in this typhoon- the good, the bad, and anything that comes in between.

Seeing the whole sky - Pitfalls

You've felt, experienced and observed the powers, pros and advantages of AI. The capabilities are limitless, and hence, comes the thought: What is that other side- the disadvantages or cautions that also need to be taken care of?

- **Misinformation & Hallucinations** : AI sounds confident, even when it is wrong or giving incorrect facts/information for a question you have asked. It can cause problems in cases where accuracy is paramount.
- **Privacy concerns**: You're sharing data whenever you write/type in any AI platform; who sees it? How is the data processed or used? The decision of whether to allow data to be accessed for training is in your hands.
- **Screen time overload**: Social media has become an integral part of human lives for quite some time. With the exponential growth of AI acting like "agents", the usage of digital devices has only increased. If you are always asking AI for the simplest of tasks, even when we don't need to, then it is a problem.
- **Overdependence**: Humans are gifted the ability to think. If you delegate the same to AI, you lose the ability over the time.

 Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which are the most concerning problems about AI?
- Have you ever accepted AI output without verifying its truth?

This adverse calamity presents an opportunity for you to bring mindfulness into play while using AI. The thunder roars and presents solutions to avoid the blunders any further.

Weather the storm - Pause

There are always two sides of a coin. While there are some cons of using AI, you can mitigate its impact by staying alert and mindful.

- Start by trying a simple digital detox: Choose a time daily for no screens. It can be as little as 30 minutes to an hour. Choose to walk, write anything you feel in your journal, read a book, spend time with your loved ones, or simply breathe.
- Use AI to design your break: "Suggest a 30-minutes of nature-based self-care ritual with no screens or devices". Notice how your body and thoughts feel without constant input from digital platforms.
- Then, choose a day of the week and make it completely AI-free. While other tech is allowed, not using AI will force you to think and not make you over-reliant on it. If you have already done digital detox earlier, this will feel easy.

Also make sure not to overdo any of the detox that makes you feel burned out. The fight is not against the tools. It is against the overuse. Balance is key.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What's the longest you have gone without AI/screens/devices?
- What emotions rise when you're disconnected from either of these?

The typhoon grows stronger, rain falls with higher intensity, and the wind forces to consume you. Suddenly, three shields arrive to protect you from all sides while you are still swimming the deep waters...

New shields - Ethics, Privacy & Safety

Ethics, copyrights and ownership of the AI-generated content are very much important with its exponential increase in usage. Here are some questions which you should always ask yourself before using any AI-generated output:

- Does this output respect others' rights, voices, and identities? (*others* can be any of an individual, a gender, a country an organization or a community)
- Is it promoting bias or reinforcing stereotypes?
- Am I using AI to avoid empathy or connection with real people?

You think about others with ethics. Protecting your privacy and safety is equally important while dealing with AI:

- Never enter personal or financial data into AI tools if you do not wish to reveal your identity. (It includes images, docs, codes, etc.)
- Use anonymous or alternate names for sensitive queries.
- Try to check whether not using your prompts for training the AI is present. Select the option whenever you use AI for personal questions.
- Read privacy policies (yes, really-even the skimmed version will do) to understand how the data is stored and processed.
- Choose tools that allow local storage or private mode, whenever needed.

You are the human in the loop. It means responsibility starts with you.

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Where do you draw the line between ease and ethics?
- Have you ever shared something sensitive without thinking?

Quest 5 The Skilled Swimmer

As you swim smoothly, the typhoon calms after a long time, the hut you saw earlier is gone- just like your myths- and a mystic ray of light appears in front of you, marked with your fifth quest. Accept it, complete it and the device to capture the light - Prism of Balance - will be yours.

Reflect & Decide on one or more of these prompts by writing in your notes app or your journal or any notebook:

- "What boundaries do I want to set with AI technology starting today?"
- "What parts of me feel louder when the screens and devices are off?"
- "What would I do with an hour of reclaimed presence every day?"

Once written, choose one pitfall you've encountered—screen overload, overreliance, privacy hesitation-and design a small ritual to shift it.

Examples:

- Use AI to plan your first "AI tech-free Sunday."
- Journal your device habits using a daily check-in prompt.
- Teach one friend or family member a privacy tip you learnt.

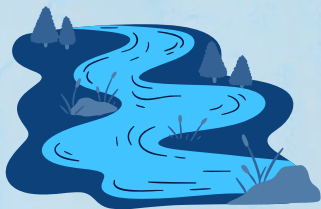
This way, you will find the loopholes you need to plug while using your devices, AI tools, screens or any technology, in general.

*Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Prism of Balance*



Realm 6

The Lake of Awareness



The stillness that sees

The typhoon passes, and you store the light in the prism, which guides you from waterfall to a lake, quite different from the one you encountered in zeroth realm.

The lake is wide and serene- glasslike in its stillness. There is no rush here. Only reflection.

You kneel at the edge. Your reflection stares back—not only your face, but also your habits, intentions and patterns. You learnt that every step you take is stored forever. The tools you hold and skills you honed have changed how you live, think and even dream.

But here, the question is different:
"Who am I becoming with all this newfound power?"

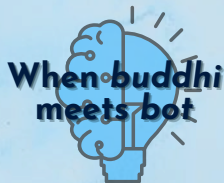
In this realm, ancient insights meet modern innovation. You'll learn to walk the path of conscious use.

Not every moment needs a prompt. Not every idea needs automation.
Sometimes, the wisest use of AI is knowing when not to use it.

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Why do you think we need awareness after we already learned about balance earlier when it comes to AI and other technologies?
- What age-old practices can be combined with AI to make your life better?

The lake has the presence of pebbles on its sides, which act like a set of great ornaments.



In Yogic philosophy, *Buddhi* means intellect- the entity which is responsible for decision-making on the basis of experiences and memory (*Chitta*) of an individual. Its capabilities are limitless.

Manas means mind, and is another part of our brain- responsible for choosing the more appropriate between resolution and uncertainty. When it is in serene state, it can make the right choice. But, it can get confused during times when it isn't. *Manas* also occasionally causes conflict with *Buddhi*, since it is very restless. It is *buddhi* which wisely chooses what is necessary.

AI is more like *manas*- which even though possesses a lot of memory, knowledge and information- often struggles to choose the right. We must control the AI models in order to reduce uncertainty. Organizations which create or build AI models have put checks at every place in order to reduce the uncertainty, lack of ethics, and other such challenges. This is where *buddhi* meets the bot- where power of AI is used with awareness, mindfulness and right intentions.

It is your intellect which is absolutely important when you use AI models. Harmony is when you :

- Let AI suggest, not decide.
- Remember that your intuition isn't outdated-just needs to be used along with AI.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- When do you feel most like you discerning self-online or offline?
- Are you using AI to deepen self-awareness or avoid it?

As sun shines brightly, the light reflects from the still lake even more, creating an enchanting atmosphere for you to behold.

The flare of intentions

Mindful AI use begins with asking why. Before you prompt or build anything, ask yourself these:

- "What is my real intention here?"
- "Will this create clarity or clutter?"

Try to practice the following:

- Before asking AI anything, sit quietly for 60 seconds.
- Then, write your intended outcome. Let your request be shaped by clarity, not urgency. It may also happen that you choose not to use AI for certain tasks simply because of this.

Aparigraha means non-attachment in yoga. Not clinging to stuff, ideas, and yes, even data, will make you even more aware.

Let AI serve you, but do not seek for constant input or praise from it.

Suggestions:

- Delete old chats when they are not needed anymore.
- Let go of perfection in your digital creations and prompts.



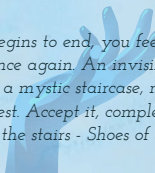
Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What AI or other digital habits are you most attached to?
- What's one area where you want to slow down using tech? What are you afraid of missing out on, if you step back?

Quest 6 **The Wise Wanderer**



As the lake begins to end, you feel the surreal atmosphere once again. An invisible hand guides you to a mystic staircase, marked with your sixth quest. Accept it, complete it and the gear to climb the stairs - Shoes of Stillness - will be yours.



Design and complete your own AI+digital awareness ritual. Start with something small, intentional, and sacred.

Ideas:

- A tech-free morning ritual with silence, workout (like yoga, resistance training or HIIT) and meditation.
- Read more about the technology behind AI tools at least one hour per week to stay aware of what is under the hood.
- Creating a "side space" area in your home where no tech is allowed. (SIDE is an acronym for Screens, Internet, Devices & other Electronic gadgets)
- Utilize AI only for certain hours of a day for two weeks.

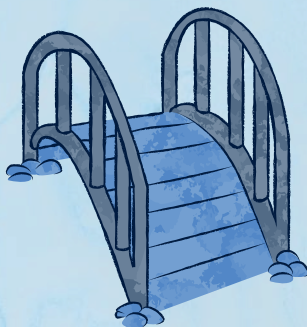
Note: Do this after completing the quest-5 for best results.

*Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Shoes of Stillness*



Realm 7

The Bridge of Future





The horizon unfolds

The shoes help you climb the stairs faster, with ease. As you take the last step, you see a long wooden bridge in front of you, above a river.

As you stand at the bridge, one side behind you glows with learning- different realms you've travelled, tokens you've earned and insights you have gathered.

Ahead, the world stretches wide- full of unknowns.

The wind here hums softly. It carries a message: "What you've learnt was never just for you."

This realm is not about answers anymore. It's about alignment.

What kind of future will you help shape?
What kind of person will you be in that future?

This is where mastery matures into legacy.



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- What's one small way you've already changed the approach to life with AI?
- Who around you may benefit from what you've learned so far?

Your small steps towards the unknown creates a stir in the river beneath, with every water droplet reverberating 'intent' and 'impact'.

**Small steps,
big impact**

You don't need to be an AI expert to shape the future.
You need to be intentional. You need to be conscious.

Consider this:

- You ask AI for better mental and physical health routine and share that wisdom with friends.
- You use AI to learn faster and then teach others how to do the same.
- You build healthier habits and ripple that out into your home, team, or community.

This is how futures change. Quietly & collectively.

Let AI support you and your surroundings, not dominate either.

Use it to:

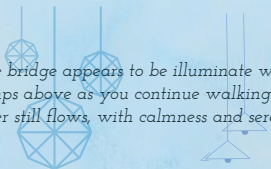
- Create presence of efficiency, not pressure of overdependence.
- Inspire inner stillness, not infinite scrolling.

Ideas:

- Curate a pipeline of multiple AI tools to maximize the efficient usage for a weekend project you were avoiding since long.
- Build rituals with AI as a silent co-guide (e.g., AI prompts to reflect on values)

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Where in your life can AI amplify meaning along with productivity?
- How does your digital behavior reflect my deeper values?



The bridge appears to be illuminate with lamps above as you continue walking. The river still flows, with calmness and serenity.



Learn with purpose

Learning how to learn:

In a world where tech evolves daily, adaptability beats expertise. Your real edge is this: You now know how to ask, refine, and learn-forever. Tips for staying up-to-date and open:

- Use AI to generate questions and test yourself before jumping into new topics.
- Create your own personal "university" with AI-curated learning paths on topics that interest you.
- Pair AI with real-world reflection, practice, and feedback. Constantly "update" yourself while staying ethical and intentional.

Purposeful prompting:

The future is not only built on tools, it is also built on trust. Ask yourself such questions regularly whenever you use AI:

- "Am I using AI to manipulate or to empower?"
- "Do my prompts reflect curiosity, control or chaos?"
- "Am I spreading wisdom or noise by creating something using AI?"

Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- How could you use AI to finally begin that learning path that you wanted to start but never did until now?
- What ethical boundaries matter the most to you in using AI? Will you keep using AI ethically in future?

Quest 7

The Intelligent Human



The dots appear connected across the realms as you reach on the other end. A mystic puzzle appears in front of you, marked with your seventh quest. Accept it, complete it and the souvenir to remember this journey - Map of Intention - will be yours.

This is an opportunity to sketch your vision:

- Which areas of your life will AI support over the next 3 months?
- Who do you want to share this journey with?
- What boundaries will you set to stay grounded?
- How will you use AI in processes and places where it isn't used currently & you intend to use?

Write a short AI Manifesto—a personal vision statement for how you'll use AI going forward.

Include:

- Your intention.
- Your ethics, morals and values.
- Your impact of using and sharing AI-generated content.
- Your commitment to learning & sharing with others.

Once completed, you've earned the token:
The Map of Intention



Realm ∞ **The Questioning Continues**



This is just the beginning

You've collected all tokens and travelled all realms. But this isn't the end. This is the beginning of you creating, choosing, leading, and listening with clarity and courage.

Your legacy has already begun. Will you light the path for others?

You have crossed the threshold, wandered through a forest, climbed a mountain, rafted on the waterfall, survived a typhoon, strolled beside a still lake, and walked through the bridge.

You've seen both the shimmer and the shadow of AI. You envisaged your future with AI. And now, you arrive not at a finish line—but at a clearing.

There is no final destination. "Only evolving questions. And now, you become a mapmaker of your own world. Keep asking and learning!"



Self-reflection Checkpoint:

- Which idea has most shifted your perspective about AI?
- How has your relationship with technology changed?
- What is your "why" for continuing this journey further?



Thank you for reading this book till the end! This book is free to share with others. Your journey may be personal, but it doesn't have to be solitary. An Inquisitive Queue (AIQ) is a growing community of curious & conscious explorers like you. If you found this book useful, please consider supporting us by following/subscribing for free on platforms below (can be accessed by clicking on the respective logo):



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AIQ's upcoming books:

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3. Important Quadrants: A minimalist framework for living simply in a wired world (AIQ Purpose Series)
4. Inward Quantum: Using data to build small wins and lasting habits (AIQ Data Series)

About the author

Harshil Shah is a certified Yoga Teacher, an engineer currently exploring Data Science & AI, a voracious reader, and a thinker forming the connections between mind, body, and technology. AIQ has been created as a publication by him for the very same intention.

About AIQ

An Inquisitive Queue is a community about finding answers on pressing questions related to fitness, mental health, climate change, leadership, technology & beyond. To read a detailed 'about', click [here](#).

The end of one journey is the beginning of another.

The map you followed was made with care.

The next map will be made by you.

- With curiosity,

AIQ.

